

1970: Xerox PARC

February: SRAM

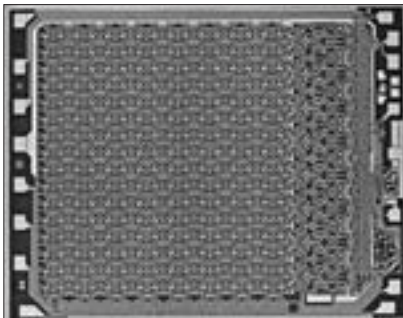
The first 256-bit Static RAM, called the 4100, was introduced by Fairchild Semiconductor in 1970, designed by H T Chua.

After selling silicon chips that carried memory, Intel publicly released the first Dynamic Random Access Memory (DRAM) chip, known as the 1103, in October. It was the first generally-available 1024 bits Dynamic RAM (DRAM) memory chip. The advantage of the 1103 chip was its speed; it had a lower access time, even though being “dynamic,” it had to be refreshed several times a second. It was expensive, but a success nevertheless.

Eventually, semiconductor companies realised the benefits of saving time as well as cost and the performance advantage of semiconductor memories over the then-predominant magnetic ferrite core memories.

March: An intelligent robot

Shakey, the first mobile robot controlled by artificial intelligence, was created by SRI. Equipped with sensing devices, like TV camera and bump sensors, to monitor the environment; and driven by a problem-solving program called STRIPS, the robot found its way around the halls of SRI by applying information about its environment to a route. The environmental data collected by Shakey was transmitted to a DEC PDP-10 and PDP-15 which then radioed back commands to Shakey—which acted accordingly.



The first bipolar 256-bit Static RAM: the Fairchild 4100